

CHECKPOINT PLANNING

Financial Clarity for Life's In-Betweens

YOUR NEXT CHECKPOINT

The Divorce Financial Checkpoint Guide

A simple guide to the financial questions behind the legal ones.

Scott Marcoe, CRPC™

Founder & Financial Planner, Checkpoint Planning

(949) 702-0139 | scott@checkpointplanning.com | checkpointplanning.com

How to Use This Guide

This guide is designed to support you during divorce, separate from, but alongside, the legal process. It offers a simple way to organize the financial side of your situation before you finalize a settlement.

What this guide is:

- A tool to help you understand the financial implications of divorce
- A place to capture questions to bring to your attorney or a financial planner
- A simple structure for evaluating a proposed settlement

What this guide is not:

- Legal advice or a substitute for your divorce attorney
 - Tax advice
 - A guarantee of any particular financial outcome
-

Where You Are Today

Divorce affects finances and emotions together. Before reviewing the numbers, take a moment to acknowledge where you're starting.

- What worries me most about the financial side of this process:
- Three words that describe how I feel about money right now:
- What I most want to protect financially:

There is no need to solve these today. Naming them is the first step toward clarity.

Five Things to Understand Before You Sign

1. The Real Value of a Settlement

A settlement's headline number isn't the same as its after-tax, after-cost value. A dollar in a Roth IRA is not the same as a dollar in a traditional 401(k) or a dollar of home equity.

Question to answer: Have I evaluated the after-tax value of each asset in the proposed settlement, not just the total?

2. QDROs and Retirement Account Division

Dividing a 401(k) or pension typically requires a Qualified Domestic Relations Order (QDRO), a separate legal document from your divorce decree. IRAs are divided differently, through a transfer incident to divorce.

Question to answer: Do I understand which accounts require a QDRO, and has one been drafted correctly?

3. Tax Filing Status and Support

Your filing status changes, and the tax treatment of spousal support depends on when your agreement was finalized. Child support is generally not deductible or taxable; spousal support rules vary by agreement date.

Question to answer: Do I understand how my tax situation changes in the first year after divorce?

4. A New Household Budget

Rebuilding a cash flow plan for a single household, often on a single income, is one of the most immediate practical needs after divorce.

Question to answer: Have I built a realistic budget based on my post-divorce income and expenses, not my pre-divorce ones?

5. Insurance and Beneficiary Updates

Life insurance, health coverage, and beneficiary designations on retirement accounts are easy to overlook after a divorce is final, and easy to get wrong if left unchanged.

Question to answer: Have I updated every beneficiary designation and insurance policy that still names my former spouse?

Settlement Snapshot

Use this to organize what's on the table before you evaluate it.

Asset / Account	Proposed Allocation	Tax Treatment	Notes
Home / real estate			
401(k) / retirement accounts			
Investment accounts			
Business interests			
Debt			
Spousal / child support			

My First 90 Days Checkpoint

First 30 days, Stabilize

- Open individual bank and credit accounts if you haven't already
- Confirm health insurance coverage going forward
- Delay any major financial commitments until the settlement is finalized

Next 30 days, Clarify

- Build a post-divorce household budget
- Identify one professional to talk to about the settlement (financial planner, tax advisor)

Final 30 days, Rebuild

- Update beneficiary designations and insurance
 - Set a savings and investment plan for your new household
-

Decisions I Do Not Need to Make Yet

Not every financial decision needs to happen immediately. Write down what can wait.

- Decisions I can delay:
 - Earliest date these decisions need to be reviewed:
-

Questions to Bring to a Professional

- Questions for my attorney:
 - Questions for a tax professional:
 - Questions for a financial planner:
-

If You Would Like Additional Support

This guide is designed to help you gain financial clarity during divorce. If you'd benefit from a deeper, confidential conversation about your specific situation, support is available.

Schedule a complimentary Where We Begin session. It is not a financial plan and there is no obligation of any kind, a structured, confidential space to review where you are, what's changed, what decisions matter now, and what can wait.

Scott Marcoe, CRPC™

Founder & Financial Planner, Checkpoint Planning

P: (949) 702-0139

E: scott@checkpointplanning.com

www.checkpointplanning.com

This material is for educational purposes only and is not tax, legal, or investment advice. Please consult your attorney or tax advisor regarding your specific situation. Scott Marcoe offers products and services using the following business names: Checkpoint Planning – Capstone Financial Group – insurance and financial services | Ameritas Investment Company, LLC (AIC), Member FINRA/SIPC – securities and investments | Ameritas Advisory Services, LLC (AAS) – investment advisory services. AIC and AAS are not affiliated with Capstone Financial

Group.

© 2026 Checkpoint Planning. All rights reserved.